

Communication Skills in Nursing



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Course objective

After the completion of this course the student will be able to:

- To convey messages clearly, ensuring the recipient understands the intended meaning without confusion.
- To listen attentively and understand the message being communicated, which is essential for meaningful dialogue and problem-solving.
- To enhance communication through body language, facial expressions, gestures, and tone, supporting the verbal message.
- To foster positive relationships by communicating with empathy, respect, and consideration for others' perspectives.
- To handle disagreements and misunderstandings in a constructive and peaceful way, encouraging collaboration and problem-solving.
- To use communication to motivate, persuade, or inspire others toward a particular viewpoint or action.
- To express emotions appropriately and regulate them for better understanding and to prevent misinterpretations.

- To share information effectively, ensuring the receiver understands the message, which aids in decision-making and collaboration.
- To adjust communication style to different audiences, situations, and contexts, ensuring effective communication in diverse settings.
- To express ideas confidently and assertively, while respecting others' views, which leads to clear and decisive communication.

1. Introduction ➡

- Communication is the basic element of human interactions that allows people to establish, maintain and improve contacts with others.
- Effective interpersonal communication skills between health care providers and client/patients are one of the most significant factors for improving client/patients' satisfaction, compliance and overall health outcome
- It is essential that nurses develop and maintain an understanding of the methods and skills of communication in order to meet the needs of the client/patient.
- Nurses have an important role in the care of client/patients in a variety of healthcare settings. Therefore, every point of contact can be an opportunity to improve client/patient care and relationships using effective communication
- The quality of care provided is dependent on the quality of communication that exists between the nurses and their client/patients
- When nurses communicate effectively with interest, listen actively and demonstrate compassion, client/patients may be more likely to report their experiences as positive, even at times of distress and ill health.

- The clients who understand details of their illness and treatment, whom perceive and believe the provider is concerned about their well-being, often show greater satisfaction with the care received and are more likely to follow with treatment regimes.



2. Definition of Communication

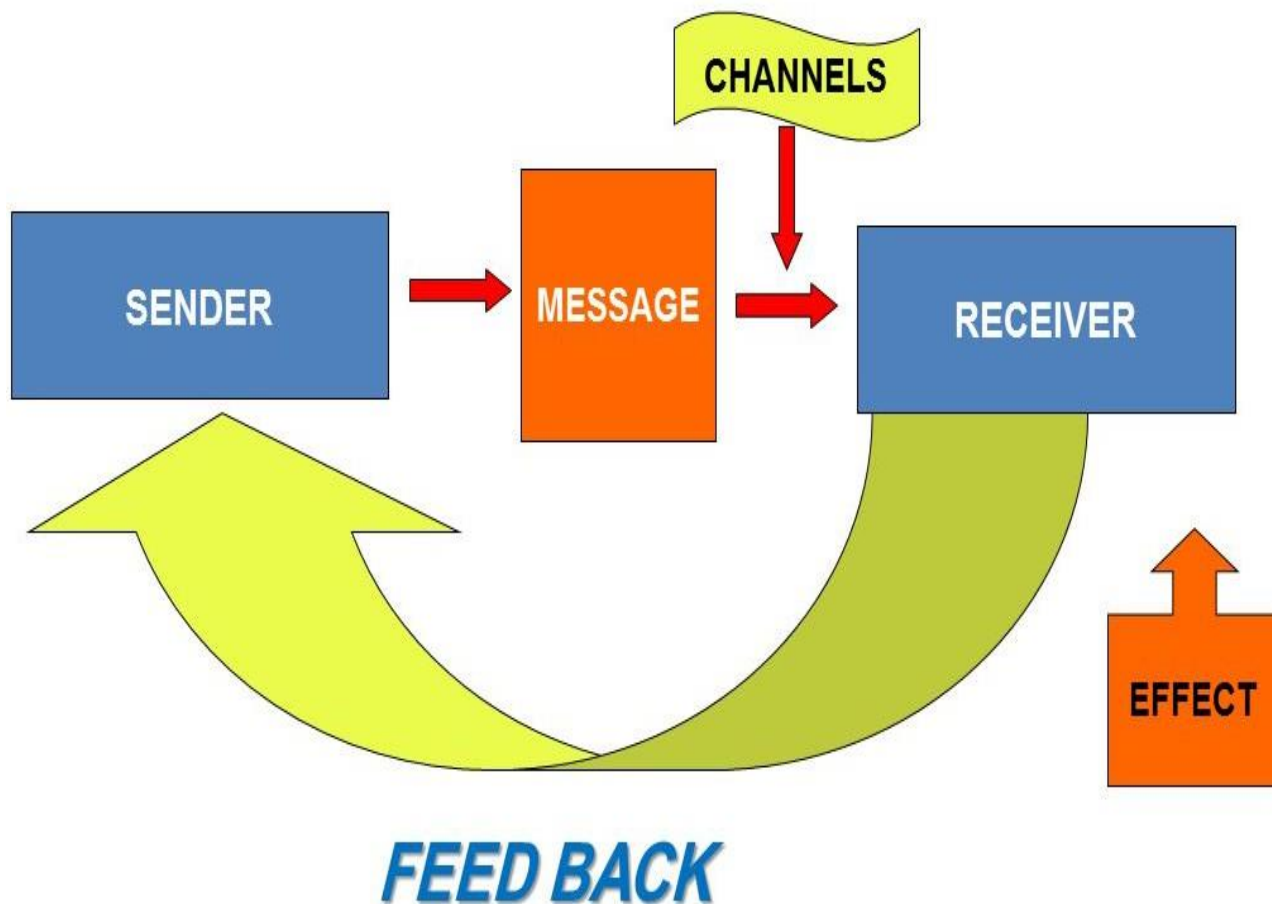
- The word communication originates from ‘communis’, a Greek word, meaning ‘to make common’. Communication is “a process by which people exchange ideas, facts, feelings or impressions in ways that each gains a ‘common understanding’ of meaning, intent and use of a message.
- In general, communication refers to the reciprocal exchange of information, ideas, facts, opinions, beliefs, feelings & attitudes through verbal or nonverbal means between people
- It includes listening and understanding with respect, as well as expressing views and ideas and passing information to others in a clear manner
- Communication is an art, and like any art it is a learning skill influenced by the presence of special talent in some persons

3. Why communication is important?

- Effective communication is the basis of mutual understanding & trust.
- Gets your point across.
- Informs and Educates.
- Helps in rapport building
- Helps in Co-operation in treatment and rehabilitation.
- Stimulates new ideas
- On the other hand Poor communication causes a lot of misunderstanding, hinders work & productivity.

4. Elements of Communication

The Six Elements of Communication



1-Sender:

- A sender is a person who encodes & sends the message to the expected receiver through an appropriate channel.

The impact of the message will depend on sender's communication skill, social status (authority), knowledge, attitude and prestige in the community.

2-Message:

- The message is the content of communication & may contain verbal or nonverbal language.
- Perception & personal factors of the sender and receiver may sometimes distort this element so the intended outcome of communication may not be achieved.

For example, the same message may be communicated or perceived differently by two individuals.

3-Channel:

- A channel is a medium through which a message is sent or received between two or more people.
- Several channels can be used to send or receive the message, i.e. seeing, hearing, touching, and smelling, writing & feeling.
- While selecting channels of communication, several factors must be considered: availability of channels, purpose, suitability, types of receivers, types of message, preference of sender & receivers, communication skills of the sender, cost, etc.

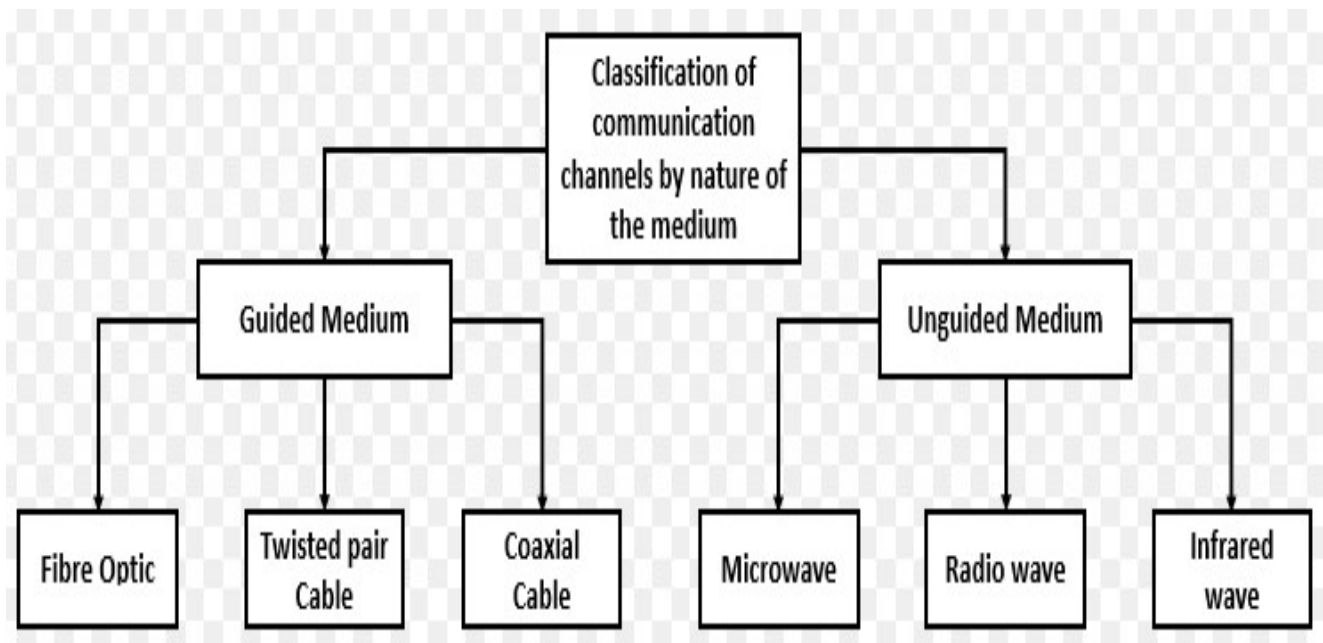
Classification of channels of communication:

- Visual channel:** Facial expression, body language, posture, gestures, pictures & written words, electronic mails, mass media, etc.
- Auditory channel:** Spoken words, sounds, telephone or mobile communications, delivering audio content (radio, voicemail), etc.

- **Tactile channel:** Touch sensations, therapeutic touch, etc.
- **Combined channel:** Audiovisual media, consoling a person with touch & spoken words.

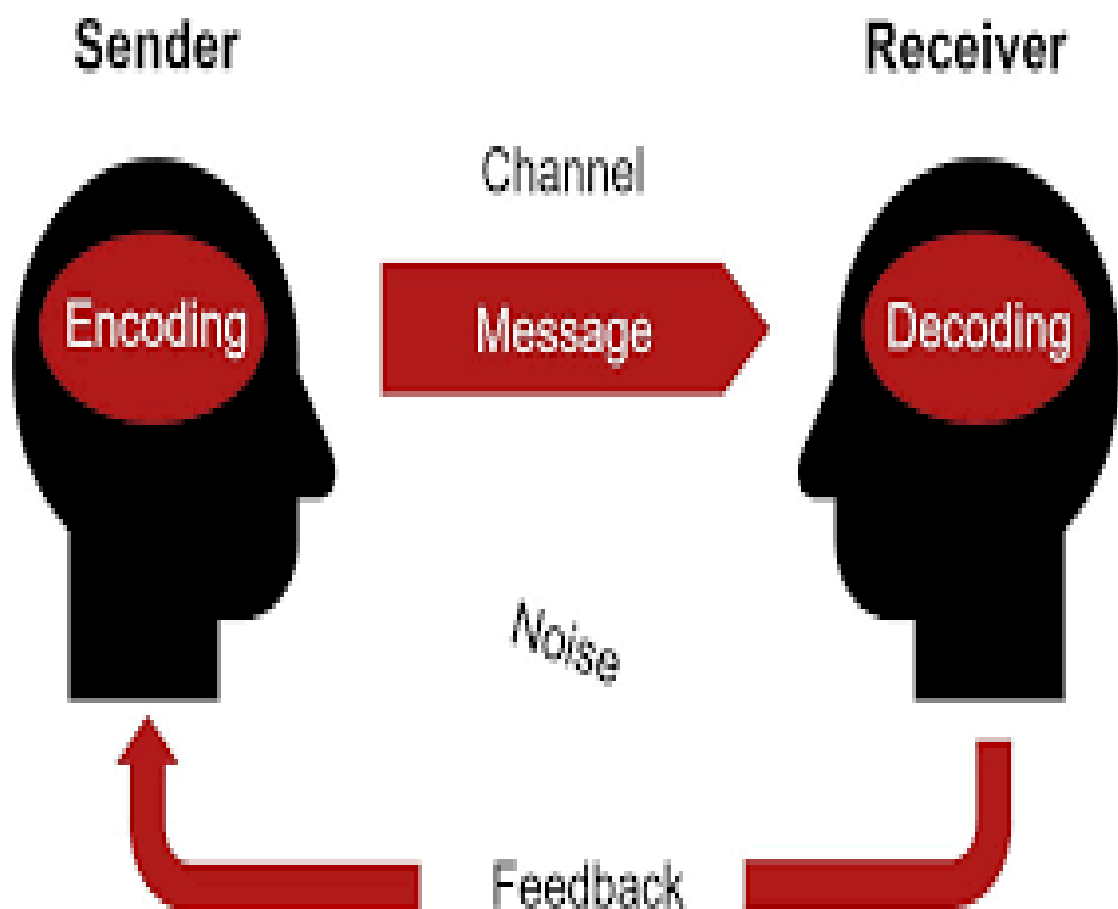
Every channel of communication has its advantages and limitations.

The proper selection and use of channels results in successful communication



4-Receiver:

- A receiver is an individual or a group of individuals intended to receive, decode & interpret the message sent by the sender/source of message and give feedback.
- He is expected to have the ability & skills to receive, decode & interpret the message
- A receiver also known as decoder.
- Communication has only taken place if the message being sent was accurately received



5-Feedback:

- It is a return message sent by the receiver to the sender.
- It is most essential element of the communication process as it shows that the receiver has understood the primary message sent by the sender.
- A successful communication must be a two-way process where the sender sends the message & receives feedback from the receiver.
- The feedback could be positive or negative
 - ✓ Positive feedback: the receiver accepted the concept of the message.
 - ✓ Negative feedback: the receiver resisted the concept of the message.

6-Effect

The effect of communication is the end results of the communication process which could be emotional, cognitive or physical.

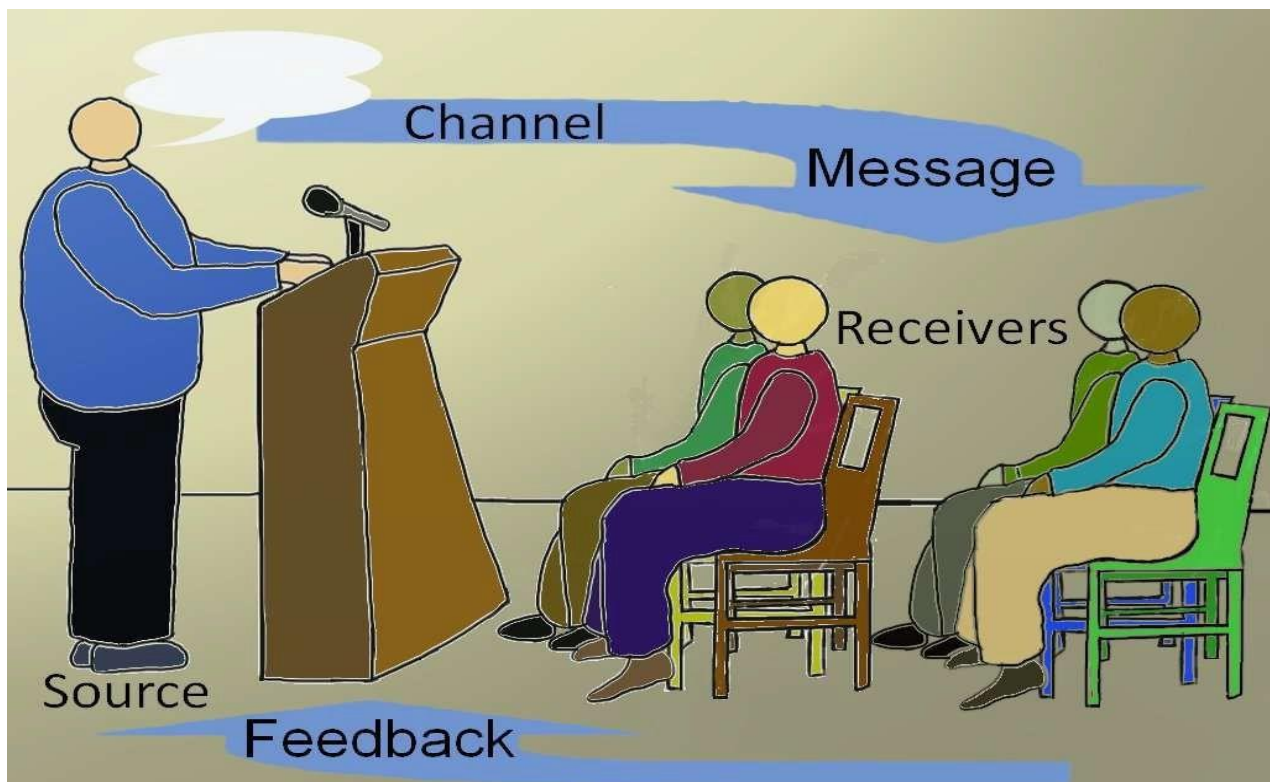


Settings of Communication

1-**Intrapersonal**: it is communication that occurs in your own mind. It is the basis of your feelings, biases, and beliefs. E.g. the person communicates with himself through thinking

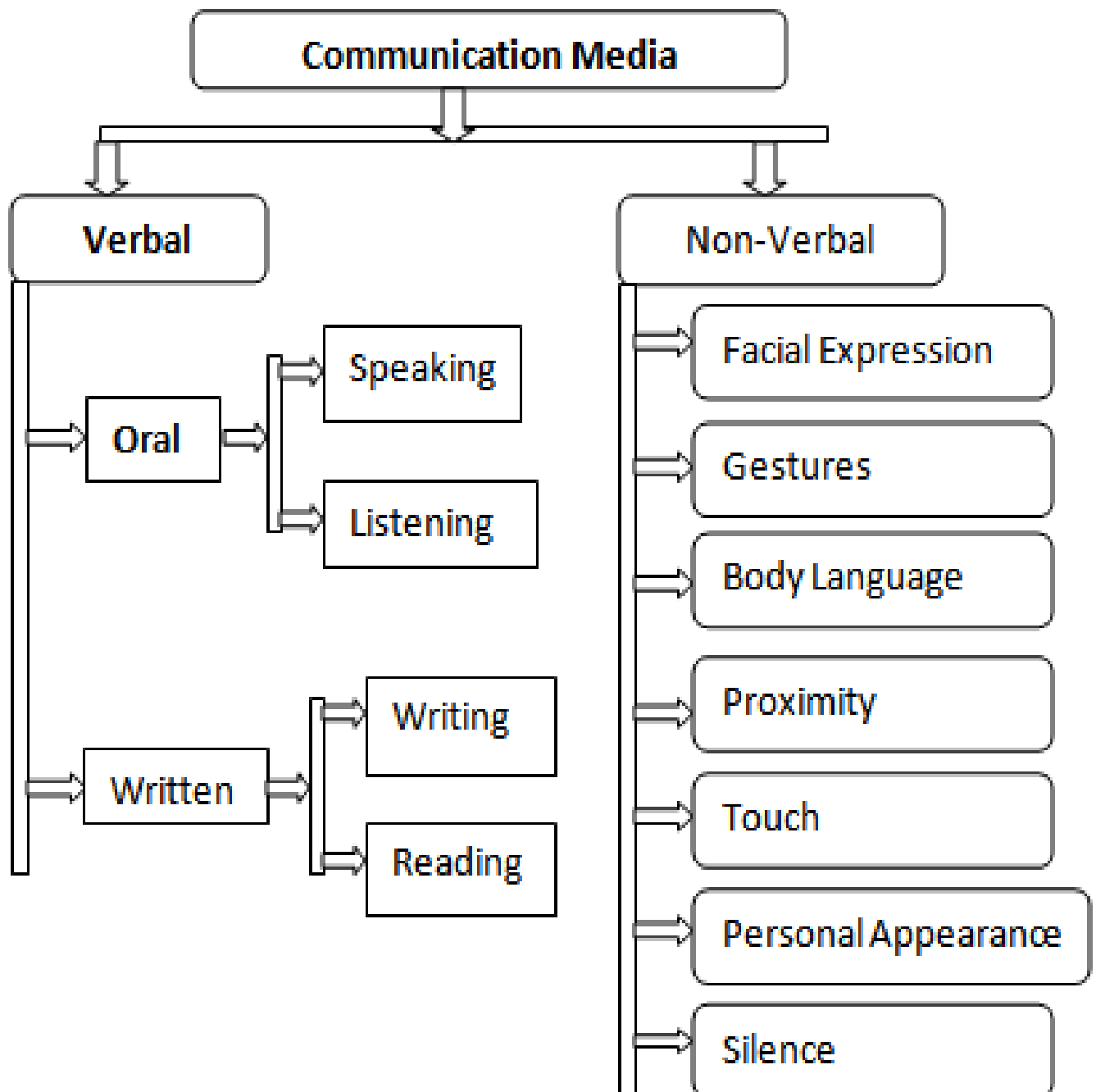
2-**Interpersonal**: people in a face to face

- Person to person
- Small group communication 3-15 usually share a common purpose
- Public speaking one person and audiences in public setting, lecture hall, etc.



3- **Mass communication**: large mass people don't know each other & usually not in the same place radio or television or the internet.

5. Types of Communication



A) Verbal communication:

- It occurs through the medium of spoken or written words.
- A combination of several words is used & each word conveys a specific meaning.
- **Some important elements of verbal communication are**

Appropriate and Clear language, vocabulary building, clarity, consciousness, preciseness, comprehension, briefness, timing & relevance

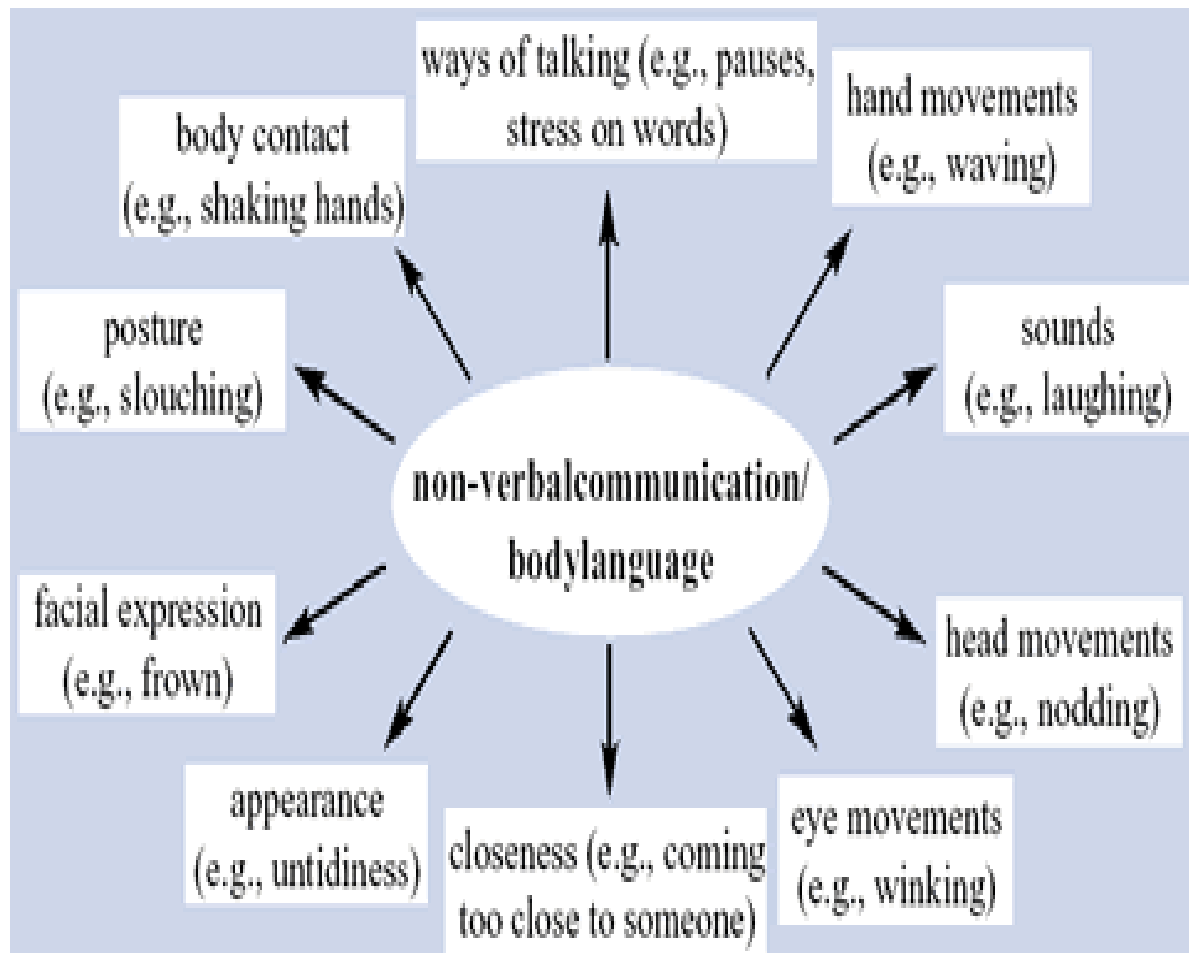
Words should be meaningful and suitable to the listeners, consider the demographic factors: age, sex, education and interest of target group

B) Non-Verbal Communication:

The term non-verbal communication is used to describe all human communication that is not written or spoken, refers to an exchange of information without the exchange of spoken words (facial expressions, body language, etc.).

- This communication occurs without words; where the five senses & whole range of body movements, posture, gesture, facial expressions & silence are used for sending & receiving the message.
- Nonverbal communication is a more accurate way of communication because it convey the true & intended meaning of the message
- Body Languagespeaks louder than words. A person will generally pay more attention to what you do than what you say.

- Nonverbal communication may be accomplished by the following means:



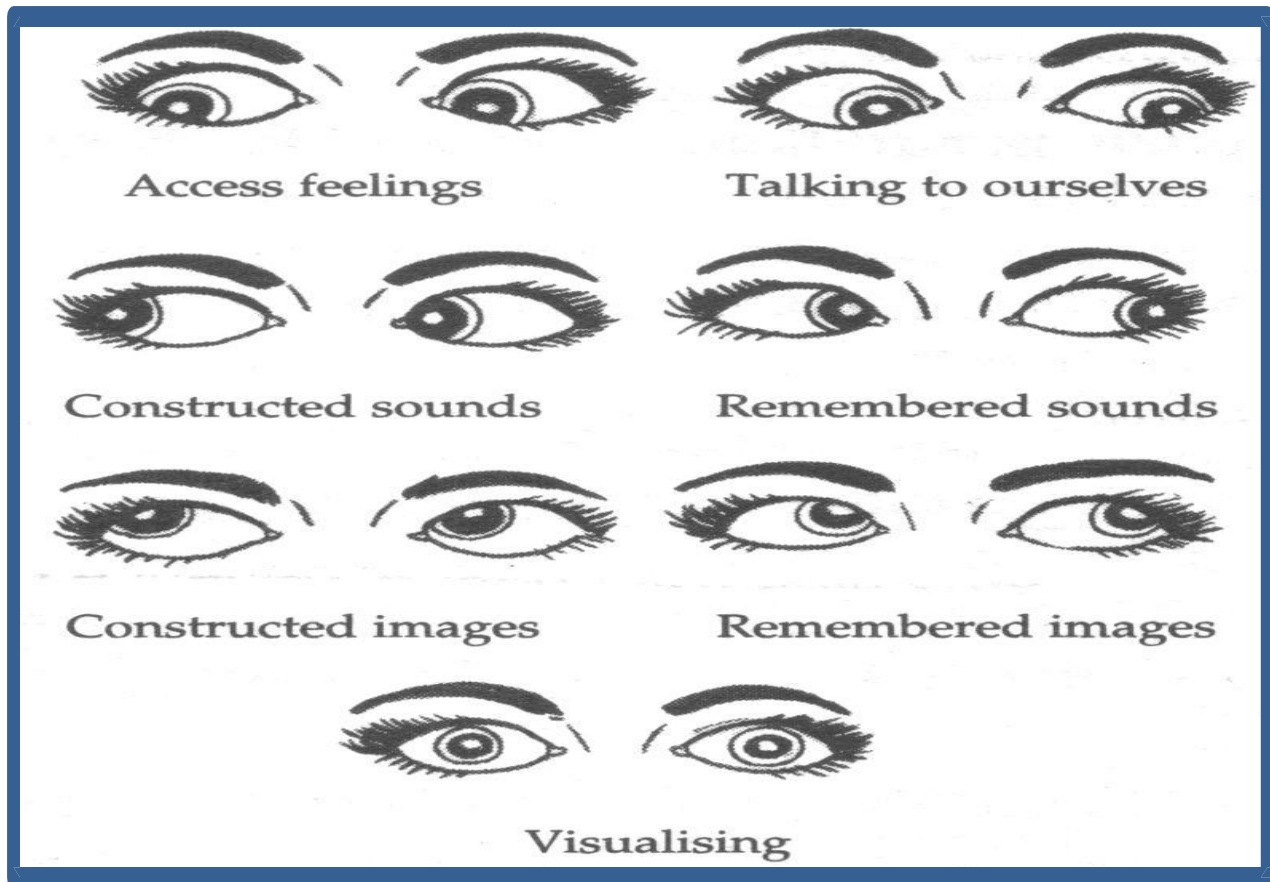
- **Physical appearance:**

- When you deliver a speech, your appearance conveys a powerful visual message to the audience
- Enhance your appearance through proper clothing, grooming, and physical conditioning.



- **Facial expression**





- **Eye contact**

- After your voice, your eyes are your most powerful tool for communication.
- Eye contact has very much in face-to-face communication.
- It builds the rapport between the speaker & the listener.
- Absence of eye contact shows lack of interest & understanding.
- The speaker must look in to the eyes of the audience this will built up the confidence & eliminate the nervousness.
- The speaker must read the eye cues

- **Maintain proper eye contacts level**

Eye Contact



- **Touch:** it is a powerful mean of communications for elderly and children



- **Posture and gesture**

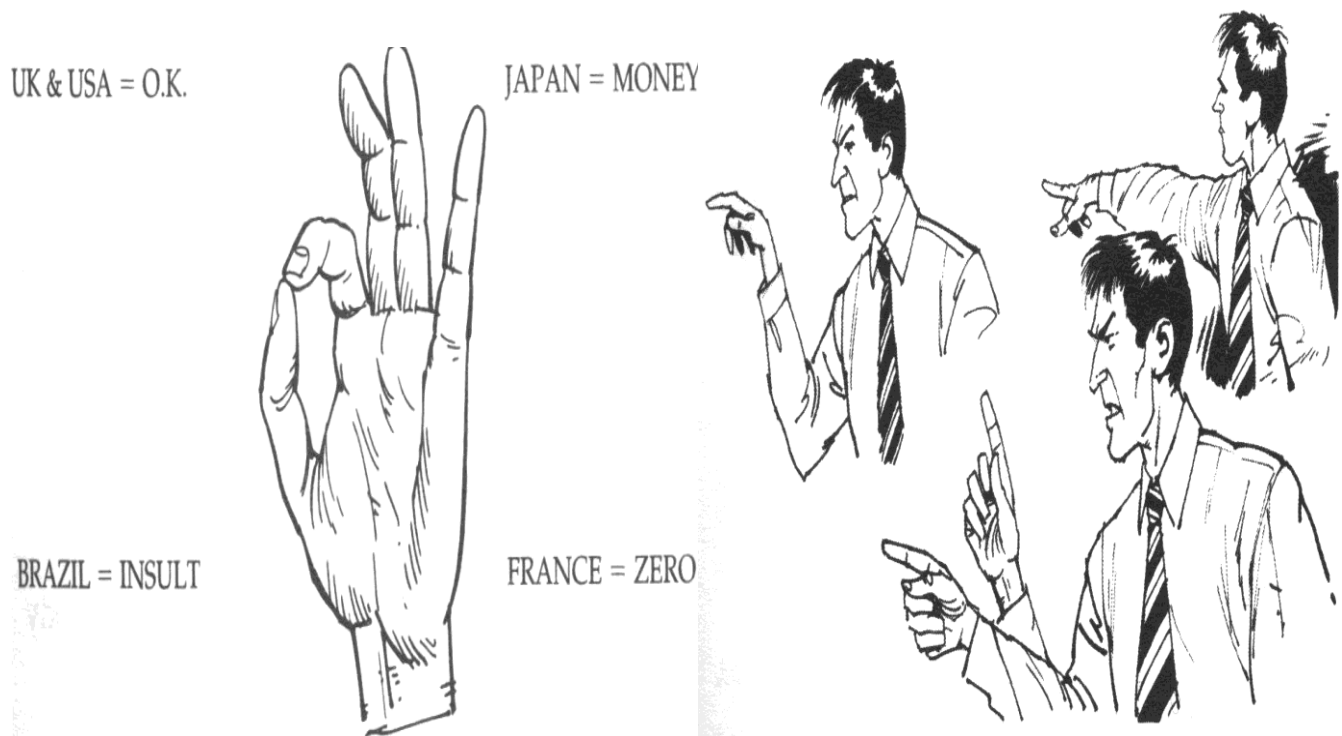
A gesture is a specific bodily movement that reinforces a verbal message or conveys a particular thought or emotion. Although gestures may be made with the head, shoulders, or even the legs and feet, most are made with the hands and arms



- Putting the hands on the head = confusion
- Rubbing the forehead = deep thinking
- Open relaxed fists = trust, confidence
- Nods & shades of the head convey agreement & disagree

- **Finger and hand movement:**

How you hold and move your hands and fingers are particularly insightful in reading people.



- **Distance**

- Intimate (touching to 45cm)
- Personal (45cm to 1.2m)
- Social (1.2m to 3.6m)
- Public (3.7m to 4.5m)

- **Para Language:** Non-verbal aspects of speech:

- ✓ Pitch of voice
- ✓ Volume: highness or lowness of voice
- ✓ Rate or Speed of speech: rapid rate-++ interest or confusion

- **Silence:** It can be used to express a wide range of feelings (listen to silence)

Using silence for

- ✓ Organize thoughts, prepare for the next
- ✓ Encouraging the client/patient to communicate "open up."
- ✓ Allowing client time to revise what has been said
- ✓ Allow client time to collect thoughts
- ✓ Allow client time to consider alternatives
- ✓ Look interested
- ✓ Uncomfortable silence should be broken



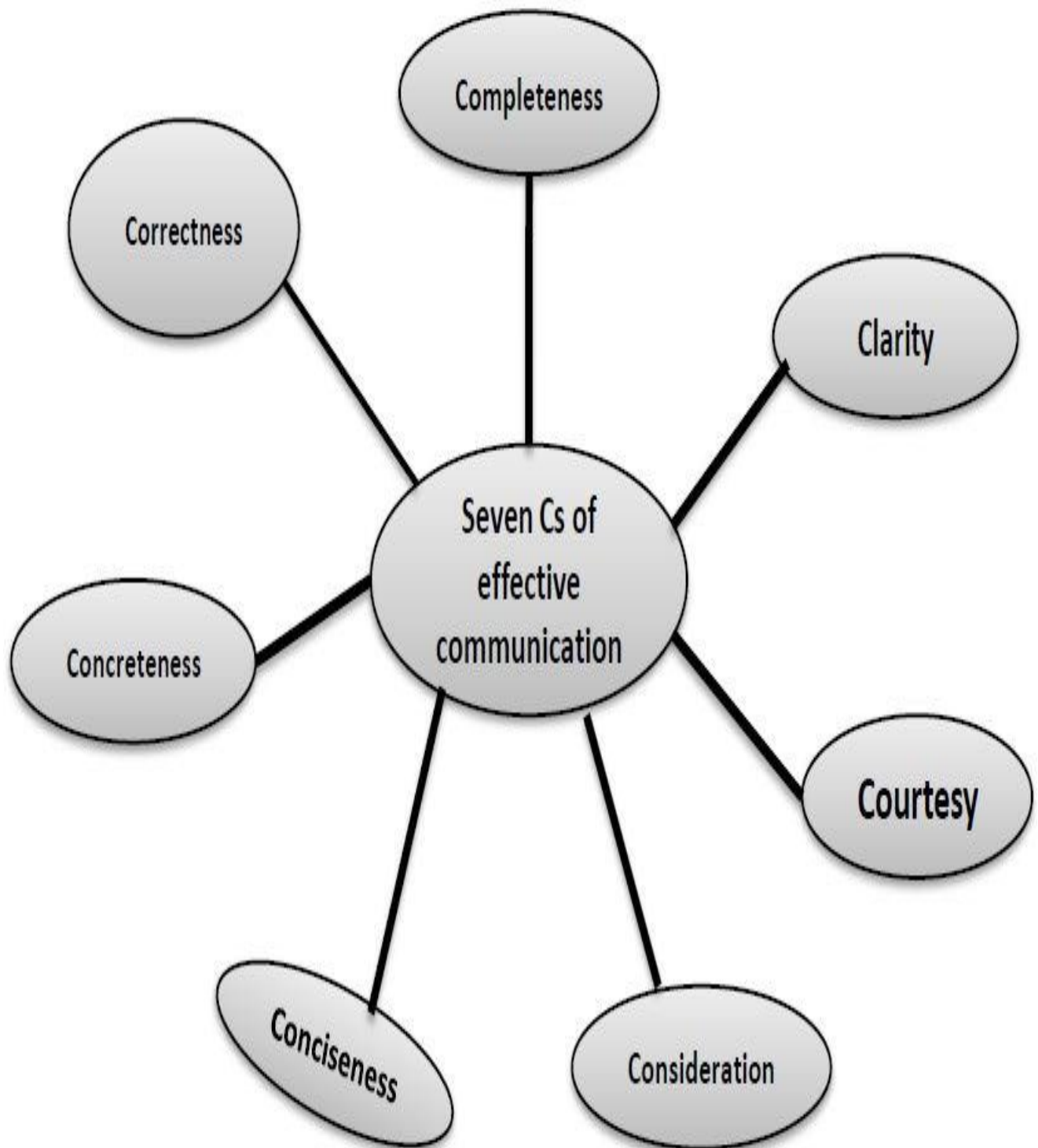
- **Functions of Non-Verbal Communication**

1. Reinforces the verbal message
2. Complements the verbal message
3. May replace the verbal message
4. It may contradict the verbal message
5. Improving Non-Verbal Communication
6. Observe non-verbal communication of others

- **Effective communication**

- Effective communication is the communication which produces intended or desired result
- Effective communication helps to connect well with others and understand a person or situation in a better way.
- It enables us to solve the differences, build trust and respect in the organization.
- Sometimes our message is misunderstood or we misunderstand the received message, effective communication helps us to resolve these problems.
- It helps us in decision making.

- **The 7cs of effective communication**



1. Completeness

- Complete information always gives additional information wherever required; it leaves no question in the minds of the receiver.

2- Conciseness

- Conciseness means communicating what you want to convey in the least possible words.
- Concise communication provides short and essential messages in limited words.
- Concise messages are more appealing and comprehensive to the audience.

3- Consideration

- Effective communication must take audience into consideration by knowing the viewpoints, back ground, mindset, educational level, etc.
- Consideration implies stepping into the shoes of others.
- Consider the needs and requirements of the audience to achieve effective communication.

4-Clarity

- Clarity implies emphasizing on a specific goal or objective at a time, rather than trying to move away from track.
- Clarity helps to understand the message easily.
- Clarity comes with the use of exact, appropriate and concrete words.

5- Concreteness

- Concrete communication implies being particular and clear rather being fuzzy and general.
- Concrete communication shows good level of confidence.
- Concrete information cannot be misinterpreted

6-Courtesy

- Courtesy means being polite, kind, enthusiastic and convincing.
- Courtesy reflects the nature and character of the sender of the message.
- It is the same as giving respect and then expects the same.

7- Correctness

- Correct information includes the precision and accurateness of facts and figures used in the message
- Free from grammatical errors and use of appropriate and correct language.
- Correctness in the communication implies that the correct information is conveyed through message.
- Correct communication boosts the confidence level of the sender.
- Correct information has a greater impact on the audience.

- **Skills of Effective Communication**

A-Skills that support in keeping the focus on the client:

- **Looking and listening to cues.**

Cues are hints and can be words, gestures or body language. Noticing verbal and non-verbal cues is important to understanding the client/patient's needs.

- **Asking relevant questions**

- Ask open & closed ended questions
- Ask open questions as much as possible (esp. at the start) For example: How are you?

Asking open directive questions: for example: How are you since I last saw you? 'You said you are not with it; can you tell me more about that?'

- Ask probing questions
 - ✓ Clarify: What do you mean by that
 - ✓ Justify: What makes you think of that
 - ✓ Check accuracy: you definitely took 3 tab /day
- **AVOID**
 - ✓ Talk more than the client/patient
 - ✓ confusing & complicated questions
 - ✓ Ignoring questions of the client/patient

- **Psychological focus**

- ✓ Asking the clients open ended questions about feelings.
- ✓ Recognizing and responding to emotions, feelings and concerns.
- ✓ Client/patients appreciate healthcare professionals asking about their feelings.

- **Using pauses and silence**

Pauses and silence provide a slower pace and will help the person to engage in the conversation and give them time to think about what they want to say.

- **Using minimal prompts.**

Use small, encouraging words and gestures. For example, nodding or saying, 'go on'.

- **Screening**

For example: asking the question, "Is there something else?" before continuing with the discussion.

- **Clarifying**

For example: asking the question 'you said you are not with it, from what you say, it sounds like it is hard to concentrate?'

- **Negotiating**

Negotiating and asking permission. For example: *Would it be okay to talk about what is worrying you?*

B- Skills that support effective listening:

- **Active listening**

- Most important yet most difficult
- Demonstrating that you are actively listening

- * Eye contact

- * Lean forward facing client/patient

- “Yes, I understand – please continue”

- Helping the client/patient to be relevant
 - Interrupt at appropriate point & try to redirect the interview

E.g. what you just told me about your job is very interesting, but I would like to hear more about the headache you have been having.

- You must read between the lines. Pick up the underlying meaning of the message (intent); don't rely entirely upon the obvious or superficial meaning (content) but pick up the nonverbal cues.

- Facial expressions (smile, frown, blank look, grimace).
 - Gestures/mannerisms (fidgeting, toe tapping, clenched fists).
 - Eye behaviors (avoiding eye contact, staring, wide eyes).
 - Posture (erect, leaning toward/away from someone).

- **Reflecting.**

- Repeating the client's message Verbal or nonverbal
- Reflecting content repeats client's statement, May be misused or overused
- Reflecting feelings
- Verbalizing implied feelings in client's comment
- Encourages clients to clarify

- **Acknowledging.**

Showing a response to what you are noticing or hearing. For example: I can see you are very upset about this.'

- **Summarizing.**

- Never be afraid to summaries what the client/patient has told you
- Summarize & Check accuracy

e.g. *"I would like to make sure that I have been understanding you correctly, you told me that . "*

"What I hear from you is that ... Did I get that right?"

- Highlighting the main ideas expressed
- Conveys understanding
- Review's main themes of conversation
- Use at different times during interaction

- **Empathizing.**

- Empathy means putting yourself in another person's place
- Empathy is neither sympathy (feeling sorry for another person) nor compassion (that quality of love or tenderness that causes one person to suffer along with another).
- Respond to the client/patients' emotional questions and tell the client/patient everything about his/her case even if he/she does not ask
- Saying something to show you appreciate (not sympathize) how the other person seems to be feeling.

For example: *‘Everything has happened so fast, no wonder you are finding it difficult to take in.*

- **Paraphrasing.**

Put the focus of the paraphrase on what the other person implied, not on what you wanted him/her to imply, e.g., don't say, *“I believe what you meant to say was ...”*. Instead, say *“If I’m hearing you right, you conveyed that ...?”*

C- Skills that help with giving information:

- Checking what information, the person knows already.
- Giving small amounts of information at a time, using clear terms and avoiding jargon.

- Avoiding detail unless it is requested – do not assume people want to know.
- Checking understanding using an open question. For example: *‘I have gone through some difficult information, what sense have you made of it?’*
- Pausing and waiting for a response to what you have said before moving on.
- Checking, with sensitivity, the effect of the information you have given on the client For example: *‘There has been a lot of information to take in today, how are you feeling?’*

Communication Barriers

I. personal perception barriers

- Misunderstanding
- Poor retention due to memory problem
- Lack of attention
- Discomfort due to illness
- Hearing problems
- Poor listening skills
- Information overload
- Gender physiological differences
- Level of intelligent

II. Environmental barriers

- Loud background noise
- Poor lighting and Lack of ventilation
- Uncomfortable setting
- Unhygienic surrounding & bad odor
- Very hot or cold room
- Distance
- Lack of privacy

III. Psychological barriers

- Distrust & unhappy emotions
- Emotional disturbances
- Psychotic or neurotic illness
- Worry & emotional disturbances
- Fear, anxiety & confused thinking
- Negative attitude towards the communicator:
 - Client thinks that he/she knows everything
 - Client feels embarrassed as he/she cannot comply with the advice due to financial constraints.

IV. Social barriers

- Differences in social norms, values & behavior
- Social taboos
- Different social strata

V. Cultural barriers

- Ethnic, religious & cultural differences
- Cultural tradition, Belief, values & behavior
- Level of knowledge & understanding
- Language

VII. Organizational barriers

- Organizational policy, rules & regulation
- Technical failure
- Time pressure
- Complexity of organization structure due to hierarchy

VIII. Communication process-related barriers

- Unclear & conflicting message
- Stereotypical approach
- Inappropriate channels
- Lack of or poor feed
- Contradictory messages:

When the client gets different messages from different sources



Methods to overcome barriers of communication

I. Methods to overcome physiological barriers

- Keep in each other's retention & recollection abilities.
- Pay attention during the sharing of information
- Ensure each other comfort.
- Ensure the intactness of sensory perception.
- The limitation of hearing abilities must keep in mind.
- Active listening.
- avoid Information overload

II. Methods to overcome environmental barriers

- Good lighting must be ensured to facilitate nonverbal communication.
- A comfortable seating arrangement.
- A hygienic & odor-free environment

III. Methods to overcome psychological barriers

- Happy & trustworthy manner

- Should not harbor negative emotions
- Avoid feeling of prejudice, resentment & antagonism.
- Free from fear, anxiety & confusion

IV. Methods to overcome social barriers

- The difference in social norms, values & behavior must be give consideration.
- Social beliefs must be kept in mind.

V. Methods to overcome cultural barriers

- Consider cultural differences
- Consider cultural traditions, values & behavior.

VII. Methods to overcome organizational barriers

- Considered Organizational policy, rules & regulation.
- Organization structure must be simple & noncomplex
- Large organization must divided into smaller subset

VIII. Methods to overcome communication process-related barriers

- An appropriate channel must be used.
- A stereotypical approach must be avoided in communication.
- The message must be clear & none conflicting
- Proper feedback must be ensured by the recipient.



Therapeutic Communication

What Is Therapeutic Communication?

Therapeutic communication is a collection of techniques that prioritize the physical, mental, and emotional well-being of patients. Nurses provide patients with support and information while maintaining a level of professional distance and objectivity. With therapeutic communication, nurses often use open-ended statements and questions, repeat information, or use silence to prompt patients to work through problems on their own.

What are the three main purposes of therapeutic communication?

Therapeutic communication is face-to-face communication between a nurse and patient. The three main purposes of therapeutic communication for a nurse are: (1) to provide education to patients, (2) to provide support to patients, and (3) to establish a relationship in which the patient feels free to express any concern.

Therapeutic Communication Techniques

There are a variety opens of therapeutic communication techniques nurses can incorporate into practice.

☐ **Using Silence**

At times, it's useful to not speak at all. Deliberate silence can give both nurses and patients an opportunity to think through and process what comes next in the conversation. It may give patients the time and space they need to broach a new topic. Nurses should always let patients break the silence.

☐ **Accepting**

Sometimes it's necessary to acknowledge what patients say and affirm that they've been heard. Acceptance isn't necessarily the same thing as agreement; it can be enough to simply make eye contact and say "Yes, I understand." Patients who feel their nurses are listening to them and taking them seriously are more likely to be receptive to care.

☐ **Giving Recognition**

Recognition acknowledges a patient's behavior and highlights it without giving an overt compliment. A compliment can sometimes be taken as condescending, especially when it concerns a routine task like making the bed. However, saying something like "I noticed you took all of your medications" draws attention to the action and encourages it without requiring a compliment.

☐ **Offering Self**

Hospital stays can be lonely, stressful times; when nurses offer their time, it shows they value patients and that someone is willing to give them time and attention. Offering to stay for lunch, watch a TV show, or simply sit with patients for a while can help boost their mood.

☐ **Giving Broad Openings**

Therapeutic communication is often most effective when patients direct the flow of conversation and decide what to talk about. To that end, giving patients a broad opening such as "What's on your mind today?" or "What would you like to talk about?" can be a good way to allow patients an opportunity to discuss what's on their mind.



☐ **Active Listening**

By using nonverbal and verbal cues such as nodding and saying “I see,” nurses can encourage patients to continue talking. Active listening involves showing interest in what patients have to say, acknowledging that you’re listening and understanding, and engaging with them throughout the conversation. Nurses can offer general leads such as “What happened next?” to guide the conversation or propel it forward.

☐ **Seeking Clarification**

Similar to active listening, asking patients for clarification when they say something confusing or ambiguous is important. Saying something like “I’m not sure I understand. Can you explain it to me?” helps nurses ensure they understand what’s actually being said and can help patients process their ideas more thoroughly.

☐ **Placing the Event in Time or Sequence**

Asking questions about when certain events occurred in relation to other events can help patients (and nurses) get a clearer sense of the whole picture. It forces patients to think about the sequence of events and may prompt them to remember something they otherwise wouldn’t.

☐ **Making Observations**

Observations about the appearance, demeanor, or behavior of patients can help draw attention to areas that might pose a problem for them. Observing that they look

tired may prompt patients to explain why they haven't been getting much sleep lately; making an observation that they haven't been eating much may lead to the discovery of a new symptom.

☐ **Encouraging Descriptions of Perception**

For patients experiencing sensory issues or hallucinations, it can be helpful to ask about them in an encouraging, non-judgmental way. Phrases like “What do you hear now?” or “What does that look like to you?” give patients a prompt to explain what they're perceiving without casting their perceptions in a negative light.

☐ **Encouraging Comparisons**

Often, patients can draw upon experience to deal with current problems. By encouraging them to make comparisons, nurses can help patients discover solutions to their problems.

☐ **Summarizing**

It's frequently useful for nurses to summarize what patients have said after the fact. This demonstrates to patients that the nurse was listening and allows the nurse to document conversations. Ending a summary with a phrase like “Does that sound correct?” gives patients explicit permission to make corrections if they're necessary.

☐ **Reflecting**

Patients often ask nurses for advice about what they should do about particular problems or in specific situations. Nurses can ask patients what they think they should do, which encourages patients to be accountable for their own actions and helps them come up with solutions themselves.

☐ **Focusing**

Sometimes during a conversation, patients mention something particularly important. When this happens, nurses can focus on their statement, prompting patients to discuss it further. Patients don't always have an objective perspective on what is relevant to their case; as impartial observers, nurses can more easily pick out the topics to focus on.

☐ **Confronting**

Nurses should only apply this technique after they have established trust. It can be vital to the care of patients to disagree with them, present them with reality, or challenge their assumptions. Confrontation, when used correctly, can help patients break destructive routines or understand the state of their situation.

☐ **Voicing Doubt**

Voicing doubt can be a gentler way to call attention to the incorrect or delusional ideas and perceptions of patients. By expressing doubt, nurses can force patients to examine their assumptions.

☐ **Offering Hope and Humor**

Because hospitals can be stressful places for patients, sharing hope that they can persevere through their current situation and lightening the mood with humor can help nurses establish rapport quickly. This technique can keep patients in a more positive state of mind.



Importance Of Communication In Nursing

Effective communication is a core skill for all healthcare professionals and nursing staff in particular, since nurses spend more time with client/patients and relatives than any other healthcare professional.

A critical component of nursing practice is Good communication skills as it has the following advantages:

- ✓ It Generates trust between nurse and clients.
- ✓ It provides professional satisfaction.
- ✓ It is a means for bringing about change, i.e. nurse listens, speaks and acts to negotiate changes that promote client's well-being.
- ✓ It helps to promote managerial efficiency.
- ✓ It Provides basis for leadership action.
- ✓ It Provides means of co-ordination.
- ✓ It is an essential element of client/patient safety and quality

hospital care.

- ✓ It is the foundation of the relationship between the nurse and other members of the health team
- ✓ It affects all aspects of the nursing job and the client/patient experience as it involves everyone the nurse interact with, including:
 - Communication with nurse managers and administrators
 - Nurse-to-nurse communication
 - Nurse-to-physician communication, plus interactions with other staff
 - Nurse–client/patient communication, and communication with their family



Guidelines for effective nurse Communication with Client/patients

The following tips can enhance nurse–client/patient communication in most settings

A. Establishing the Setting.

- Provide a comfortable environment (lighting, temperature, furnishings).
- Establish a relaxed, unhurried setting.
- Sit down when speaking to the client/patient.
- Face the speaker and maintain eye contact and proper eye level.
- Keep privacy and confidentiality.
- Avoid interruptions and other distracting influences.

B. beginning of the interview

- Greeting your client/patient
- Ask client/patient to sit down
- Introduce yourself and address your client/patient by name
- Create rapport: The harmonious feeling with mutual respect, acceptance, and understanding.
- Explain the need to take not

C. Main part of the nurse client/patient interview.

- Accept and respect the client/patient despite the symptoms of his illness.
- Convey to the client/patient and family that they are important to you and that you want to help them.
- Communicate with each client/patient as an individual not as a case (In order to do so, you must try to get to know the client/patient, Listen to him and Put yourself in his place).
- Convey honesty and trustworthiness.
- Look directly at your client/patient, smile, and be conscious of body language (yours and theirs)
- Use active listening (Stop and listen -- don't let documentation or other duties distract you from important cues)
- Use language that is understandable to the client/patient.
Avoid acronyms and medical/nursing jargon
- Speak clearly and slowly; share information in small bites so as not to overwhelm
- Keep questions brief and simple
- Ask one question at a time and give the client/patient time to answer.
- Clarify client/patient responses to questions, not just for your own use, but also to let the client/patient know that you are listening and that you understand.

- Try not to overwhelm the client/patient with embarrassing or personal questions. When it is necessary to ask personal questions, explain why and keep it short and matter-of-fact
- Use the teach-back method, asking client/patients to repeat information in their own words
- Avoid leading questions. You want the client/patient to tell you what he is feeling, not what he thinks you want to hear. So avoid putting words in his mouth. For example, it might be better to ask, *"How are you feeling?"* rather than *"I suppose you're feeling rested after your nap."*
- Avoid interrupting the client/patient. If you need to ask a question, wait until he has completed his thought except he is giving irrelevant information.
- Assess each client/patient's ability to understand and comply with instructions; pull in a family member, if needed
- Give a brief explanation of what you are doing and why
- Proper use of the nonverbal communications as silence, empathy...etc
- Nurses present client/patients and families with educational materials on admission, describing their role in promoting safety

D- Ending the interview

- Enquire if your client/patient would like to add any thing
- Summarize what the patient should do in the meantime.
- Thank your client/patient

Patient-centered care communication skills

Collaboration between the patient and the healthcare team, patient-centered care incorporates the patient's values, beliefs, and preferences regarding overall health and well-being into the plan of care and implementation of all care activities.

Key concepts for implementing patient centered care.

1. Respect

- During the initial assessment, encourage patients to share their values, preferences, and needs related to health care because these will form the basis of the plan of care.
- Customize care to each patient, ensuring that it's culturally appropriate.
- To determine the patient's values, preferences, and needs, you need good interpersonal and communication skills.

2. Care coordination and integration

Care activities of all disciplines involved in the patient's care should be coordinated to heighten the focus on the patient.

3. Provide Information, communication, and education

- To help patients understand patient-centered care, provide them with key information, communication, and education.
- Ask for their help in designing the overall plan of care. Answer their questions in easy-to-understand terms, not jargon.
- To boost patients' engagement in the patient-centered care process, tailor your communication to reflect patients' needs. To do this, ask open-ended questions to gain insight into their concerns, such as:
 - ✓ Can tell me how you're feeling right now?
 - ✓ What would you like me to do for you at this moment?
 - ✓ Here's a list of self-care activities that need to be completed.
Do you have a preference as to which activities should be done first?
- Healthcare team members should discuss the pros and cons of various treatment options. Help patients understand the information you're presenting by using visual images, analogies, or other means.

4. Comfort

Ensure that the patient is physically and emotionally comfortable so he or she can actively engage in patient-centered care.

5. Family input

If the patient gives consent, incorporate input from family members into the design of the overall plan of care

Student worksheet

Answer the following questions

Choose the correct answer :

1. Why is communication considered the basic element of human interaction?

- A) It helps establish, maintain, and improve contacts with others.
- B) It is a way to exchange medical records.
- C) It is only relevant to healthcare professionals.
- D) It is used primarily for educational purposes.

2. What is one of the most significant outcomes of effective interpersonal communication between healthcare providers and clients/patients?

- A) Increased workload for healthcare providers
- B) Improved client/patient satisfaction, compliance, and overall health outcomes
- C) More paperwork for healthcare staff
- D) Reduced healthcare costs

3. Why is it essential for nurses to develop and maintain communication skills?

- A) To meet the professional expectations of the healthcare system
- B) To reduce the amount of time spent with each patient
- C) To meet the needs of the client/patient and improve care quality
- D) To improve job satisfaction among nurses

4. What role does communication play in the care of clients/patients in healthcare settings?

- A) Communication is only necessary during patient admission.
- B) Communication is irrelevant in clinical practice.
- C) Every point of contact is an opportunity to improve care and relationships.
- D) Communication only affects patient satisfaction, not the quality of care.

5. How does the quality of communication between nurses and patients affect care quality?

- A) The quality of care is entirely independent of communication.
- B) Effective communication improves the quality of care provided.
- C) Communication quality has no impact on patient outcomes.
- D) Poor communication leads to better health outcomes.

6. When nurses communicate effectively by showing interest, listening actively, and demonstrating compassion, what is likely to happen?

- A) Clients/patients may report their experiences as negative, even if they are healthy.
- B) Clients/patients may be more likely to report positive experiences, even during times of distress or ill health.
- C) Nurses will face more complaints from patients.
- D) Communication will become less important to patients over time.

7. What is a common result for clients who understand details about their illness and treatment and believe their provider is concerned about their well-being?

- A) They are less likely to follow treatment regimes.
- B) They are more likely to show greater satisfaction with the care received.
- C) They tend to avoid medical treatments altogether.
- D) They are less likely to communicate with their healthcare providers.



8. The word "communication" originates from which Greek word?

- a) Communitas
- b) Communis
- c) Communicate
- d) Community

9. What is the main purpose of communication?

- a) To entertain people
- b) To exchange ideas, facts, feelings, and impressions
- c) To create confusion
- d) To persuade others only

10. What is emphasized in the definition of communication?

- a) Only speaking
- b) Only listening
- c) Reciprocal exchange of information, ideas, facts, opinions, and feelings
- d) Writing messages only

11. Which of the following is NOT a part of communication according to the provided definition?

- a) Listening and understanding
- b) Expressing views and ideas
- c) Ignoring the message
- d) Passing information clearly

12. Communication is often referred to as which type of skill?

- a) A natural ability
- b) A mechanical skill
- c) An art
- d) A scientific skill

13. According to the definition, what is required for effective communication?

- a) Only verbal communication
- b) Special talent for some people
- c) Using high-level vocabulary
- d) Avoiding nonverbal cues

14. Communication can be done through which of the following means?

- a) Only verbal
- b) Only written
- c) Only nonverbal
- d) Verbal and nonverbal

15. What does communication help in gaining?

- a) A common understanding of meaning, intent, and use of a message
- b) A common belief
- c) A sense of superiority
- d) A personal gain in knowledge

put (true) or (false)

☐ () Communication is the basic element of human interactions that allows people to establish, maintain and improve contacts with others.

☐ () Effective interpersonal communication skills between health care providers and client/patients are one of the most significant factors for improving client/patients' satisfaction, compliance, and overall health outcome.

☐ () It is essential that nurses develop and maintain an understanding of the methods and skills of communication in order to meet the needs of the client/patient.

- ☐ () Nurses have an important role in the care of client/patients in a variety of healthcare settings. Therefore, every point of contact can be an opportunity to improve client/patient care and relationships using effective communication.
- ☐ () The quality of care provided is dependent on the quality of communication that exists between the nurses and their client/patients.
- ☐ () When nurses communicate effectively with interest, listen actively, and demonstrate compassion, client/patients may be more likely to report their experiences as positive, even at times of distress and ill health.
- ☐ () The clients who understand details of their illness and treatment, whom perceive and believe the provider is concerned about their well-being, often show greater satisfaction with the care received and are more likely to follow with treatment regimes.
- ☐ () Communication originates from the Greek word 'communis', meaning 'to make common'.
- ☐ () Communication is a one-way process of exchanging information.
- ☐ () Communication only refers to verbal exchanges of information.
- ☐ () Listening and understanding with respect are not part of communication.
- ☐ () Communication involves passing information to others in a clear manner.
- ☐ () Communication is an art and can be influenced by special talent.



- ☐ () The purpose of communication is only to exchange facts.
- ☐ () The goal of communication is to achieve a common understanding of meaning, intent, and use of a message.

